



COMMON MISTAKES GRADING AND NON-GRADING ADVERBS

Only grading adverbs can be used with gradable adjectives, and only non-grading adverbs can be used with non-gradable adjectives.

GRADING ADVERBS

This book is **very good**. ✓

This book is **absolutely good**. ✗

NON-GRADING ADVERBS

The plot is **very great**. ✗

The plot is **absolutely great**. ✓

100.5 USING ADVERBS OF DEGREE TO DESCRIBE VERBS

"Quite," "really," and "absolutely" can be used to modify verbs. These modifying words must go before the verb.

In UK English "quite" doesn't have as strong an emphasis as "really." In US English the emphasis is stronger.

I **quite enjoy** cycling.

"Quite" can be used before "enjoy" and "like."



"Really" is used to mean "a lot more."

I **really like** cycling.

"Really" can be used before "like," "love," "enjoy," "don't like," and "hate."



"Absolutely" is used in extreme forms.

I **absolutely love** cycling.

"Absolutely" can be used before "love" and "hate."



FURTHER EXAMPLES

He **quite likes** playing tennis.



I **really don't like** cooking.



He **really loves** eating cake.



She **really hates** waking up early.



She **really enjoys** playing guitar.



They **absolutely hate** singing.

